scoup.ai

scoup.ai financial package

2026-10-18

> **Pre-product. Synthetic data only. Not investment advice.**

Documents in this volume:

- financial/assumptions.md
- financial/unit-economics.md
- financial/budget.md
- financial/use-of-funds.md
- financial/scenarios.md
- financial/audit.md

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Contents

Assumptions 3
- How the statuses are used 3
- The inputs that move the answer most 3
- Inputs that changed from the investor-pack workbook 4
- Full input list 4
- Open questions for the owner 11

Unit economics 12
- Direct accounts (shippers and SME importers): definitions and base-case values 12
- Carriers (partner-led) 13
- Direct accounts by scenario 13
- The pessimistic case (sourced) 13
- The benchmark test 13
- What would change these numbers first 14

Year-1 budget 15
- Budget by department and quarter 15
- Net burn by year (base case) 15
- What each line contains 16
- Hiring plan, year 1 17
- Controls 17

Use of funds 18
- The raise 18
- Where the seed goes 18
- Milestones per tranche 19
- If the milestones are missed 19
- What changed from earlier versions 20

Scenarios: bull, base and bear over seven years 21
- What differs between the cases 21
- Headline comparison 21
- Reading the cases 24
- Sensitivities on the base case 25
- Market size and share of SAM 25
- Open questions 26

Financial model audit 28
- 1. Files audited 28
- 2. Inputs: sourced or assumed 28
- 3. Hardcoded values that should be formulas 30
- 4. Inconsistencies 31
- 5. What we reused and what we changed 33
- 6. Formula-drivenness check (recorded 2026-10-17, re-run 2026-10-18 after C14) 34
- 7. Limits of this audit 35

Assumptions

Date: 2026-10-17. Status: draft for owner review. Model: `financial/model.xlsx`, tab Assumptions.

With no customers and no revenue, scoup.ai has no history for this model to calibrate against. Of its 79 inputs, 11 are sourced from a primary or reputable secondary publication (re-checked today by us or by the market-researcher and digital-marketing agents, with links), and 68 are our own assumptions. The ratio is the honest state of a pre-product company, and we show it rather than dress assumptions up as findings. Where an assumption leans on a published figure for context (Carta for the Series A bar, Benchmarkit for churn and sales efficiency), the figure is sourced but the input we chose is still marked ASSUMED.

Every input lives on the Assumptions tab in blue. Column I carries the status and column J the source or the reasoning, and the table below is generated from the same metadata the build script writes into the workbook (`financial/tools/build_model.py`), so the two cannot drift apart. All money is in thousands of US dollars unless the label says NOK or USD. Year 1 is the first twelve months after the seed closes.

How the statuses are used

- **SOURCED**: the value comes from a named publication, with URL and access date. Re-verified on 2026-10-17.
- **ASSUMED**: our planning choice. The reasoning column says what it rests on and how we would measure it.
- **PENDING research**: none left. Market research arrived on 2026-10-17 (`research/05-market-size.md` v3): the SAM is 32,765 shipper and importer accounts ($945.4M at our segment rates), the TAM 133,256 accounts ($1,855.5M). Platform fee and recovery share stay ASSUMED, because no competitor publishes its pricing.

The inputs that move the answer most

Four assumptions decide whether the plan works, and none of them is measured.

Amount recovered per account ($52K in year 1, rising to $115K). Revenue per account is a fee on money the customer recovers, so this number drives revenue one-for-one. The $52K comes from the October business case: a mid-size importer-shipper with 2,000 TEU of imports might recover $36K of non-compliant demurrage and detention charges (15% of a $240K exposure) and $16K of fuel-surcharge overbilling. Both percentages are guesses that the first design partners will replace. A 20% shortfall in revenue per account raises the seed need from $6.91M to $7.62M and moves the Series A milestone from month 38 to month 40 (`tools/verify_results.json`, stress runs).

Sales and marketing efficiency. The plan spends $0.73 of sales and marketing per $1 of new direct ARR in year 3. The Benchmarkit 2024 median is $2.00. We kept the investor-pack plan because founder-led selling, a free review of past invoices and a channel partner from year 3 can plausibly beat the median for a while, but we treat it as the largest single risk. At $2.00 the base case would need an $11.9M seed and $38.5M of equity over seven years. A second, sourced pessimistic case uses the paid-media cost of acquiring a small-company customer, $31K (Metadata.io 2026 B2B Paid Media Benchmark, 2025 data). At that CAC the base case needs a $10.0M seed and $18.7M over seven years, and LTV ∶ CAC is 2.0x in year 3. This is why tranche 2 of the seed is tied to measured acquisition cost.

Recovery share and platform fee. The fee path (25% contingency in pilots, then a $6K-17K platform fee plus 12-17%) is the investor-pack pricing. One published reference point is far above it (Refund Retriever, a parcel-audit firm, charges 40-50%), which suggests room on price but is a different market. Market-researcher

found that none of the nine freight competitors profiled (Loop, Cass, Trax, CTSI-Global, nVision Global, Intelligent Audit, BlueCargo, Hey Bubba, FleetOptos) publishes a contingency rate, so the fee path stays an assumption that pilots must test.

Segment mix (owner decision, 2026-10-17). The owner set the go-to-market as shipper- and importer-first. New direct accounts split 50/50 between mid-market shippers and SME importers (`mix_shp`); a shipper recovers 77% of the importer amount because it has no ocean demurrage and detention (`shp_mult`, built from the $16K fuel-surcharge example plus an assumed $24K of accessorial and detention audit). Carriers are a small, partner-led segment from year 3 in the base case at $7,895 a year each (market-researcher carrier fee, `car_rec` x `car_share`), with a 20% partner commission (`partner`). If every account were a carrier instead, the base plan would need $36.0M of equity and never break even, which is why the mix is now explicit.

Churn (20% base). Contingency service is easy to switch off. The Benchmarkit median gross revenue retention of 88% is for subscription software; we assume worse retention than that median for the base case and better in the bull case.

Inputs that changed from the investor-pack workbook

Three inputs carry new values, each logged in `audit.md` section 5. The NOK/USD rate moved from 10.5 to the live Norges Bank September 2026 average of 9.3817, which makes Norwegian staff about 12% more expensive in dollars. The gross-margin path was replaced by a variable cost of revenue (8% base, 7% bull, 10% bear) plus explicit claims staff and hosting, because the old workbook counted those costs twice. The seed tranche 2 fell from $3.5M to $3.0M after re-sizing. Two inputs are new: the year-1 hiring quarter for each role (replacing a hidden 0.6 factor) and the bear-case hold on hiring for years 3 and 4.

Full input list

Key	Input	Value (Y1..Y7, or Base / Bull / Bear)	Status	Source / reasoning
`infl`	Compensation inflation per year	4%	ASSUMED	Planning assumption carried from the investor-pack workbook (grade C).
`fx`	NOK per USD	9.3817	SOURCED	Norges Bank, USD/NOK monthly average Sep 2026 = 9.3817, https://data.norges-bank.no/api/data/EXR/M.USD.NOK.SP, accessed 2026-10-17. Replaces 10.5 in the prior workbook.
`no_load`	Norway loading on gross salary (employer tax + pension + other)	1.22	ASSUMED	Employer tax zone I 14.1% is SOURCED (Skatteetaten, https://www.skatteetaten.no/satser/arbeidsgiveravgift/, accessed 2026-10-17); the remaining ~8 points (mandatory pension, insurance) are assumed.
`us_ben`	US benefits share of total compensation	30%	SOURCED	BLS Employer Costs for Employee Compensation, June 2026: benefits 30.0% of private-industry compensation, https://www.bls.gov/news.release/ecec.nr0.htm, accessed 2026-10-17. Loaded cost = wage / (1 - 0.30).
`tax`	Norwegian corporate income tax rate	22%	SOURCED	22% (DLA Piper Global Expansion Tax, Norway, https://intelligence.dlapiper.com/global-expansion-tax/?c=NO, accessed 2026-10-17). Unlimited loss carry-forward assumed; confirm with counsel.
`dso`	Days sales outstanding	60	ASSUMED	Contingency fees are invoiced after the counterparty pays the customer; 60 days assumed. Unmeasured.

Key	Input	Value (Y1..Y7, or Base / Bull / Bear)	Status	Source / reasoning
`dpo`	Days payable outstanding (non-payroll costs)	30	ASSUMED	Standard 30-day vendor terms assumed.
`capex`	Equipment capex per net new hire ($K)	3	ASSUMED	Laptop and peripherals. Software development is expensed, not capitalised.
`dep`	Depreciation life (years)	3	ASSUMED	Straight line.
`int`	Interest earned on cash	0	ASSUMED	Set to zero for conservatism.
`cash0`	Opening cash at seed close, before seed ($K)	0	ASSUMED	UNKNOWN; owner to confirm founder-funded cash and share capital (NOK 30,000 minimum for an AS).
`milestone`	Series A ARR milestone ($K)	2,500	ASSUMED	Planning target. Reference: median ARR at Series A $2.8M in 2025 (Carta, ARR at Series A, https://carta.com/data/newsletter-arr-at-series-a/, figure confirmed via search result 2026-10-17; direct fetch returned HTTP 403).
`buffer`	Cash buffer on each round	20%	ASSUMED	Planning assumption carried from the investor-pack workbook.
`seed1`	Seed tranche 1 ($K)	4,000	ASSUMED	Plan decision; sized against the Cash Flow funding-need rows.
`seed1y`	Seed tranche 1 year	1	ASSUMED	At close.
`seed2`	Seed tranche 2 ($K)	3,000	ASSUMED	Released at milestone: 5 paying customers, recovery measured on real invoices, ARR above $0.5M.
`seed2y`	Seed tranche 2 year	2	ASSUMED	Base case passes $0.5M ARR in year 2.
`seriesA`	Series A ($K)	8,500	ASSUMED	Plan decision, kept from the investor-pack plan; tested against all three scenarios.
`seriesAy`	Series A year	4	ASSUMED	Base case crosses the ARR milestone early in year 4.

Key	Input	Value (Y1..Y7, or Base / Bull / Bear)	Status	Source / reasoning
`pre`	Seed pre-money valuation ($K)	18,400	ASSUMED	Orientation only: median US seed pre-money $18.4M in Q1 2026 (PitchBook via WaveUp, grade C, not re-verified). Terms are set with the lead investor.
`bench_sm`	Benchmark: S&M spend per $1 of new ARR	2	SOURCED	Benchmarkit 2025 SaaS Performance Metrics (2024 data), median New CAC Ratio $2.00, https://www.benchmarkit.ai/2025benchmarks, accessed 2026-10-17.
`bench_grr`	Benchmark: median gross revenue retention	88%	SOURCED	Benchmarkit 2025 report: GRR 88%, same URL, accessed 2026-10-17.
`bench_nrr`	Benchmark: median net revenue retention	101%	SOURCED	Benchmarkit 2025 report: NRR 101%, same URL, accessed 2026-10-17.
`sam`	SAM: addressable shipper + importer accounts (count)	32,765	SOURCED	market-researcher research/05-market-size.md v3 (2026-10-17): 19,932 mid-market shippers (Census SUSB 2022 firms with $100M-$999.9M receipts in manufacturing, wholesale and retail, i.e. $5M-$50M freight spend at 4.68% transport-to-sales, Establish via DC Velocity 2008, grade B) + SME importers capped at 12,833 (FMC D&D pool $3.08B / $240K exposure). TAM adds carriers 72,053 and brokers 28,438 = 133,256 accounts.
`sam_usd`	SAM: annual revenue pool, shipper + importer accounts ($K)	945,400	SOURCED	market-researcher research/05-market-size.md v3: final figure at our year-7 segment rates: shippers 19,932 x $27.6K = $550.1M + importers 12,833 x $30.8K = $395.3M = $945.4M; range $0.61B-$1.01B because the shipper/importer overlap is unknown. TAM $1,855.5M (133,256 accounts: SAM + 72,053 carriers x $7,895 + 28,438 brokers x $12K, broker rate assumed). Replaces the flat-rate $1,009.2M SAM / $4.10B TAM. Supersedes the withdrawn v2 figures ($474.2M SAM, $10.30B TAM, $8.99B SAM).
`pess_cac`	Pessimistic CAC: paid-media cost per small-company customer ($K)	31	SOURCED	Metadata.io, 2026 B2B Paid Media Benchmark Report (2025 data, 153 advertisers): small-company customer cost $31k, https://metadata.io/md/benchmark-report-2026.md, accessed 2026-10-17. Media cost only; excludes sales labour. LinkedIn cost per customer $58,572 (same source, reported by digital-marketing, not re-verified by finance).
`fee`	Platform fee	0 / 6 / 10 / 13 / 15 / 16 / 17	ASSUMED	Investor-pack workbook (grade C). Hybrid fee starts in year 2. No competitor publishes pricing (market-researcher research/01-competitors.md, 2026-10-17), so there is no market check.
`recov`	Amount recovered for the customer	52 / 70 / 85 / 95 / 105 / 110 / 115	ASSUMED	Year 1 $52K = business-case base for a mid-size importer-shipper (D&D $36K + fuel surcharge $16K), built on FMC and EIA/ATRI figures; grows as modules are added. Not measured on any customer data.
`share`	Recovery share (contingency %)	25% / 17% / 14% / 12% / 12% / 12% / 12%	ASSUMED	25% pilot contingency, falling once the platform fee starts. No freight competitor publishes a contingency rate (market-researcher research/01-competitors.md, 2026-10-17). Only public reference: Refund Retriever (parcel audit) 40-50%, https://www.refundretriever.com/pricing, accessed 2026-10-17.
`mix_shp`	Shipper share of new shipper + importer accounts	50%	ASSUMED	Owner decision 2026-10-17: shipper- and importer-first. 50/50 split assumed; SME importers are counted (234,023, US Census) but mid-market shippers are not yet.

Key	Input	Value (Y1..Y7, or Base / Bull / Bear)	Status	Source / reasoning
`shp_mult`	Shipper amount recovered vs importer path	0.77	ASSUMED	A domestic mid-market shipper has no ocean D&D. Business-case year-1 example: fuel-surcharge recovery $16K (business case, EIA-based) + accessorial and detention invoice audit $24K (assumed) = $40K vs $52K for an importer = 0.77.
`car_rec`	Carrier: amount recovered per carrier ($K/yr)	39.475 / 39.475 / 39.475 / 39.475 / 39.475 / 39.475 / 39.475	ASSUMED	market-researcher research/02 and 05 (2026-10-17): $471.60 fee per power unit x 16.7 units = $7,895 per carrier at a 20% fee, so recovered = $7,895 / 20% = $39.5K. Built on assumed inputs (400 stops per truck, $100 per detained stop, 30% winnable); ATRI 39.3% detention rate sourced.
`car_share`	Carrier: contingency share (no platform fee)	20%	ASSUMED	Fee used in the research carrier model and in gtm.md.
`partner`	Partner commission on carrier revenue (factoring / ELD channel)	20%	ASSUMED	Carriers come through a channel partner, not direct sales; commission booked in the Sales department.
`churn`	Annual logo churn	20% / 15% / 30%	ASSUMED	Share of start-of-year accounts lost in the year. Benchmarkit median GRR 88% implies ~12% revenue churn for SaaS; a contingency service is easy to switch off, so 20% base.
`rmult`	Revenue per account vs base path	1 / 1.15 / 0.8	ASSUMED	Bull: larger recoveries and early platform-fee adoption. Bear: recoveries 20% lower.
`scale`	Headcount and spend scale vs base plan	1 / 1.1 / 0.85	ASSUMED	Applied to every role except the founder, and to other operating costs from year 2.
`freeze`	Hold headcount and spend at prior-year level from year (0 = never)	0 / 0 / 3	ASSUMED	Bear cost response: if the tranche-2 milestone is missed, hold at year-2 levels (investor-pack financial plan section 4 describes this but the workbook did not model it).
`fdur`	Number of years the hold lasts	0 / 0 / 2	ASSUMED	Bear: years 3 and 4 held at year-2 levels, then the scaled plan resumes. A permanent hold would leave 2 claims analysts serving 235 accounts, which is not credible.
`varc`	Variable cost of revenue (% of revenue)	8% / 7% / 10%	ASSUMED	New input: LLM inference, OCR and per-container event data. Unmeasured; replaces the gross-margin-% input of the prior workbook.
`new_Base`	New shipper + importer accounts won - Base	6 / 30 / 75 / 120 / 165 / 200 / 235	ASSUMED	Plan input from the investor-pack workbook (grade C). No pipeline exists yet.
`new_Bull`	New shipper + importer accounts won - Bull	8 / 40 / 100 / 160 / 215 / 260 / 300	ASSUMED	Plan input from the investor-pack workbook (grade C). No pipeline exists yet.

Key	Input	Value (Y1..Y7, or Base / Bull / Bear)	Status	Source / reasoning
new_Bear	New shipper + importer accounts won - Bear	4 / 16 / 35 / 55 / 75 / 90 / 105	ASSUMED	Plan input from the investor-pack workbook (grade C). No pipeline exists yet.
car_Base	New carrier accounts via partner - Base	0 / 0 / 15 / 30 / 50 / 70 / 90	ASSUMED	Small partner-led segment starting later (base: factoring partner from year 3; bull: partner signed in year 2; bear: partner slips to year 5).
car_Bull	New carrier accounts via partner - Bull	0 / 10 / 30 / 60 / 90 / 120 / 150	ASSUMED	Small partner-led segment starting later (base: factoring partner from year 3; bull: partner signed in year 2; bear: partner slips to year 5).
car_Bear	New carrier accounts via partner - Bear	0 / 0 / 0 / 0 / 10 / 20 / 30	ASSUMED	Small partner-led segment starting later (base: factoring partner from year 3; bull: partner signed in year 2; bear: partner slips to year 5).
hc_ceo	Founder / CEO - headcount plan	1 / 1 / 1 / 1 / 1 / 1 / 1	ASSUMED	Department: G&A. Plan from the investor-pack workbook (grade C).
sal_ceo	Founder / CEO - annual pay (NOK)	1.2e+06	ASSUMED	NOK pay held below market until Series A; equals the $140K loaded in the prior workbook at 10.5 NOK/USD.
sq_ceo	Founder / CEO - year-1 start quarter (1-4)	1	ASSUMED	Hiring quarter for year-1 hires; drives the year-1 quarterly budget.
hc_swe	Software engineers - headcount plan	2 / 3 / 5 / 8 / 10 / 12 / 13	ASSUMED	Department: Engineering. Plan from the investor-pack workbook (grade C).
sal_swe	Software engineers - annual pay (NOK)	969,240	SOURCED	SSB average monthly earnings, information and communication, Nov 2025: NOK 80,770 x 12, https://www.ssb.no/arbeid-og-lonn/lonn-og-arbeidskraftkostnader/statistikk/lonn, accessed 2026-10-17.
sq_swe	Software engineers - year-1 start quarter (1-4)	2	ASSUMED	Hiring quarter for year-1 hires; drives the year-1 quarterly budget.
hc_ml	ML / data engineers - headcount plan	1 / 1 / 2 / 3 / 3 / 4 / 4	ASSUMED	Department: Engineering. Plan from the investor-pack workbook (grade C).
sal_ml	ML / data engineers - annual pay (NOK)	1.06e+06	ASSUMED	SSB sector average plus ~9% for specialist skills (ratio kept from the prior workbook).
sq_ml	ML / data engineers - year-1 start quarter (1-4)	3	ASSUMED	Hiring quarter for year-1 hires; drives the year-1 quarterly budget.

Key	Input	Value (Y1..Y7, or Base / Bull / Bear)	Status	Source / reasoning
hc_sec	Security engineer - headcount plan	1 / 1 / 1 / 2 / 2 / 3 / 3	ASSUMED	Department: Security. Plan from the investor-pack workbook (grade C).
sal_sec	Security engineer - annual pay (NOK)	1.06e+06	ASSUMED	As ML / data engineers.
sq_sec	Security engineer - year-1 start quarter (1-4)	2	ASSUMED	Hiring quarter for year-1 hires; drives the year-1 quarterly budget.
hc_ae	Account executives (US) - headcount plan	0 / 1 / 3 / 5 / 7 / 8 / 9	ASSUMED	Department: Sales. Plan from the investor-pack workbook (grade C).
sal_ae	Account executives (US) - annual pay (USD)	161,000	ASSUMED	On-target earnings, set so the loaded cost equals the $230K in the prior workbook. Not re-verified.
sq_ae	Account executives (US) - year-1 start quarter (1-4)	1	ASSUMED	Hiring quarter for year-1 hires; drives the year-1 quarterly budget.
hc_se	Sales engineer (US) - headcount plan	0 / 1 / 1 / 2 / 2 / 3 / 3	ASSUMED	Department: Sales. Plan from the investor-pack workbook (grade C).
sal_se	Sales engineer (US) - annual pay (USD)	124,900	SOURCED	BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook, sales engineers median $124,900 (May 2025), https://www.bls.gov/ooh/sales/sales-engineers.htm, accessed 2026-10-17.
sq_se	Sales engineer (US) - year-1 start quarter (1-4)	1	ASSUMED	Hiring quarter for year-1 hires; drives the year-1 quarterly budget.
hc_cs	Claims analysts / customer success (US) - headcount plan	1 / 2 / 4 / 7 / 10 / 13 / 16	ASSUMED	Department: Claims operations (COGS). Plan from the investor-pack workbook (grade C).
sal_cs	Claims analysts / customer success (US) - annual pay (USD)	70,000	ASSUMED	Analyst base pay ~$70K (prior workbook, grade C).
sq_cs	Claims analysts / customer success (US) - year-1 start quarter (1-4)	3	ASSUMED	Hiring quarter for year-1 hires; drives the year-1 quarterly budget.

Key	Input	Value (Y1..Y7, or Base / Bull / Bear)	Status	Source / reasoning
hc_mkt	Marketing (US) - headcount plan	0 / 0 / 1 / 1 / 2 / 2 / 2	ASSUMED	Department: Marketing. Plan from the investor-pack workbook (grade C).
sal_mkt	Marketing (US) - annual pay (USD)	105,000	ASSUMED	Estimate; loaded $150K as in the prior workbook.
sq_mkt	Marketing (US) - year-1 start quarter (1-4)	1	ASSUMED	Hiring quarter for year-1 hires; drives the year-1 quarterly budget.
hc_fin	Finance, legal operations, people - headcount plan	0 / 1 / 1 / 2 / 2 / 3 / 3	ASSUMED	Department: G&A. Plan from the investor-pack workbook (grade C).
sal_fin	Finance, legal operations, people - annual pay (NOK)	1.12e+06	ASSUMED	SSB sector average plus ~15%; loaded $130K at 10.5 NOK/USD in the prior workbook.
sq_fin	Finance, legal operations, people - year-1 start quarter (1-4)	1	ASSUMED	Hiring quarter for year-1 hires; drives the year-1 quarterly budget.
o_host	Cloud hosting, data feeds and tooling [COGS]	45 / 80 / 140 / 220 / 300 / 370 / 430	ASSUMED	Terraform footprint plus container-event data fees (prior workbook, grade C).
o_sec	Security programme (SOC 2, pen tests, tooling, insurance) [Security]	120 / 150 / 170 / 190 / 210 / 230 / 250	ASSUMED	SOC 2 Type II first year $50-110K and pen tests $15-35K each (vendor blogs, grade C, not re-verified).
o_legal	Legal and regulatory [G&A]	150 / 110 / 120 / 140 / 150 / 160 / 170	ASSUMED	US entity, customer contracts, FMC and data-protection counsel (grade C).
o_mkt	Marketing programmes and events [Marketing]	30 / 90 / 200 / 320 / 420 / 480 / 520	ASSUMED	Trade shows (TIA, CSCMP, TPM), content, list data (grade C). Channel CAC from digital-marketing pending.
o_trav	Travel and customer visits [Sales]	60 / 100 / 150 / 200 / 240 / 270 / 300	ASSUMED	US customer and partner visits (grade C).
o_off	Office, software, admin, accounting [G&A]	50 / 80 / 110 / 150 / 180 / 210 / 240	ASSUMED	Estimate (grade C).

Open questions for the owner

1. Opening cash and share capital at seed close (`cash0` is set to 0).
2. Founder pay: the model uses NOK 1.2M (about $156K loaded at today's rate). Confirm or replace.
3. Whether the Norwegian AS or a Delaware C-corporation will employ the US staff; this changes payroll taxes and the 22% tax rate.
4. Whether development cost should be capitalised under Norwegian GAAP; the model expenses it all.

Unit economics

Date: 2026-10-17 (revised for the owner decision on segments). Status: draft for owner review. Model: `financial/model.xlsx`, tab Unit Economics. All figures are plan outputs for a pre-product company with no customers. Nothing here is measured.

Our revenue is a share of the money we recover for a customer, plus a platform fee from year 2. The owner has set the go-to-market as shipper- and importer-first, so the unit economics below are for those **direct** accounts, won by our own sales team. Carriers come later through a channel partner and are shown separately, because their acquisition cost is a commission on revenue, not sales salaries. Read years 3 to 7: in years 1 and 2 company gross margin is negative or thin because the first claims analyst and the hosting bill arrive before revenue.

Direct accounts (shippers and SME importers): definitions and base-case values

Metric	Formula	Year 3	Year 5	Year 7
Revenue per direct account	(shipper ARR + importer ARR) / their accounts	$20.5K	$26.1K	$29.2K
Gross margin (company)	(revenue - cost of revenue) / revenue	60.3%	74.6%	78.6%
CAC	sales and marketing excluding partner commission / new direct accounts	$15.0K	$17.9K	$18.5K
Gross profit per account	revenue per account x gross margin	$12.4K	$19.5K	$23.0K
LTV	gross profit per account / annual churn (20%)	$61.9K	$97.5K	$114.8K
LTV : CAC	LTV / CAC	4.1x	5.4x	6.2x
CAC payback	CAC / (gross profit per account / 12)	14.5 months	11.0 months	9.7 months
Net revenue retention (all segments)	sum over segments of (start accounts - lost) x this year revenue per account / start ARR	102.3%	90.3%	84.2%
S&M per $1 of new direct ARR	S&M excluding partner commission / (new direct accounts x revenue per direct account)	$0.73	$0.69	$0.63

Worked arithmetic, year 3

- **Revenue per account by segment.** Importer: $10.0K platform fee + $85K recovered x 14% = $21.9K. Shipper: $10.0K + $85K x 0.77 × 14% = $19.2K (no ocean demurrage and detention). Blended over 52 shippers and 51 importers: ($996.5K + $1,116.9K) / 103 = $20.5K.
- **Gross margin.** Revenue $1,464.9K. Cost of revenue $581.7K = claims-operations staff $324.5K + hosting and data $140.0K + variable cost 8% x $1,464.9K = $117.2K. Margin = 60.3%.
- **CAC.** Sales department $852.4K less $11.8K partner commission = $840.5K, plus Marketing $281.1K = $1,121.6K, over 75 new direct accounts = $15.0K.
- **LTV and payback.** $20.5K x 60.3% = $12.4K a year; / 0.20 churn = $61.9K. Payback $15.0K / ($12.4K / 12) = 14.5 months of gross profit; cash payback is about two months longer because fees are collected 60 days after invoicing.
- **Net revenue retention.** 34 accounts at the start of year 3 (17 shippers, 17 importers), 3 of each lost. The remaining 14 shippers earn $19.2K and 14 importers $21.9K: $574.9K against start ARR of $562.1K = 102.3%. Retention falls below 100% from year 4 as 20% churn outweighs the growth in revenue per account; the Benchmarkit 2024 median is 101%.

Source: Benchmarkit, 2025 SaaS Performance Metrics (2024 data: New CAC Ratio median $2.00, GRR 88%, NRR 101%, gross margin 77%), https://www.benchmarkit.ai/2025benchmarks, accessed 2026-10-17

Carriers (partner-led)

Metric	Formula	Year 3	Year 5	Year 7
Revenue per carrier	recovered $39.5K x 20%	$7.9K	$7.9K	$7.9K
Carrier CAC	partner commission (20% of carrier revenue) / new carrier accounts	$0.8K	$2.0K	$3.0K
Carrier LTV	revenue per carrier x gross margin / churn	$23.8K	$29.4K	$31.0K

The carrier fee comes from market-researcher: $471.60 per truck x 16.7 trucks per carrier = $7,895 a year, on assumed inputs (400 stops per truck, $100 per detained stop, 30% winnable). Because the partner is paid a share of revenue rather than a fee per signed carrier, carrier CAC here is the year commission spread over new carriers, a rough measure.

Direct accounts by scenario

Metric (year 3 / year 5)	Bull	Base	Bear
Revenue per direct account	$23.6K / $30.1K	$20.5K / $26.1K	$16.4K / $20.9K
Gross margin	73.2% / 81.1%	60.3% / 74.6%	36.7% / 52.1%
CAC	$11.6K / $15.3K	$15.0K / $17.9K	$17.2K / $26.6K
LTV	$115.2K / $162.6K	$61.9K / $97.5K	$20.1K / $36.3K
LTV : CAC	10.0x / 10.6x	4.1x / 5.4x	1.2x / 1.4x
CAC payback (months)	8.0 / 7.5	14.5 / 11.0	34.4 / 29.2
Net revenue retention	105.4% / 95.0%	102.3% / 90.3%	82.8% / 78.5%

The pessimistic case (sourced)

Digital-marketing benchmarked paid channels (`marketing/digital/cac-targets.md`). Its assumed funnel converts 2.1% of leads into accounts (47.6 leads per account). Metadata LinkedIn data implies 0.345% ($202 per lead against $58,572 per customer), about 290 leads per customer. The same report puts the paid-media cost of a small-company customer at $31K. The model carries $31K as the pessimistic CAC for direct accounts (input `pess_cac`).

Base case at CAC $31K	Year 3	Year 5	Year 7
LTV : CAC = LTV / $31K	$61.9K / $31K = 2.0x	$97.5K / $31K = 3.1x	$114.8K / $31K = 3.7x
CAC payback = $31K / (gross profit per account / 12)	30.1 months	19.1 months	16.2 months

Run through the whole model (marketing spend raised until direct CAC is $31K in every year), the base case needs a $9.98M seed and $18.67M of equity over seven years, its lowest year-end cash dips to -$0.06M with the planned rounds, and EBITDA turns positive only in year 7 (+$1.12M). In the bear case, LTV : CAC at $31K is 0.6x in year 3. At LinkedIn's $58.6K per customer (reported by digital-marketing, not re-verified by us) year-3 LTV : CAC would be 1.1x.

Source: Metadata.io, 2026 B2B Paid Media Benchmark Report (2025 data, 153 advertisers), https://metadata.io/md/benchmark-report-2026.md, accessed 2026-10-17

The benchmark test

The base plan spends $0.73 of sales and marketing per $1 of new direct ARR in year 3; the 2024 Benchmarkit median is $2.00. At the median, year-3 CAC would be $2.00 x $20.5K = $41.0K, LTV : CAC 1.5x and payback 40 months. Run through the whole model, the base case would need an $11.9M seed and $38.5M of equity and would not break even within seven years.

We keep the plan CAC of about $15K because founder-led selling, a free review of past invoices that shows recoverable dollars before any contract, and partner channels carry little or no media cost. None of this is proven, and paid media is not the acquisition engine of the plan; the year-1 paid budget is a test. The tranche-2 milestone requires acquisition cost to be measured on real deals before most of the seed is spent.

What would change these numbers first

1. Measured recoveries per importer and per shipper from design partners (replaces `recov` and `shp_mult`).
2. Win rate and sales-cycle length from the first 20 founder-led deals (replaces the implied CAC).
3. Claims-analyst minutes per claim, which sets gross margin.
4. Twelve months of retention data, which replaces the 20% churn assumption.
5. The terms of a carrier channel partner (commission, volume).

Year-1 budget

Date: 2026-10-17. Status: draft for owner review. Model: `financial/model.xlsx`, tab OpEx, section "Year-1 budget by department and quarter". Base case, US dollars in thousands, quarters counted from the seed close.

Year 1 is a build-and-prove year. We start it with no customers, and the budget buys three things in this order: a product hardened enough for real customer data, a security programme that lets a shipper's IT team say yes, and design-partner recoveries that turn our assumed recovery rates into measured ones. We spend $1,025.2K in total, about $85K a month, and we plan to end the year with six people and six paying design-partner accounts: three mid-market shippers and three SME importers, in line with the shipper- and importer-first decision.

Budget by department and quarter

Department	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Year 1	Share
Engineering	0.0	63.0	97.5	97.5	258.0	25.2%
Security	30.0	64.5	64.5	64.5	223.4	21.8%
Sales	15.0	15.0	15.0	15.0	60.0	5.9%
Marketing	7.5	7.5	7.5	7.5	30.0	2.9%
G&A	89.0	89.0	89.0	89.0	356.0	34.7%
Claims operations (cost of revenue)	11.9	11.9	36.9	36.9	97.8	9.5%
Total spend	**153.5**	**250.9**	**310.4**	**310.4**	**1,025.2**	100%

Revenue in year 1 is $34.5K: an average of 1.5 shippers at $10.0K and 1.5 importers at $13.0K during the year. The operating loss before depreciation is $990.7K. After receivables, payables and $18K of laptops, free cash flow is -$976.7K, an average net burn of $81.4K a month. The model does not split revenue by quarter; quarterly burn equals quarterly spend less roughly $10K of revenue per quarter.

Net burn by year (base case)

Average monthly net burn = MAX(0, -free cash flow) / 12, from `model.xlsx`, Cash Flow tab, row "Average monthly net burn". Bull and bear are in `scenarios.md`.

	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5	Y6	Y7
Free cash flow ($K)	-976.7	-1,575.6	-2,073.6	-2,263.3	-1,279.9	+538.8	+3,254.5
Average monthly net burn ($K)	81.4	131.3	172.8	188.6	106.7	0	0

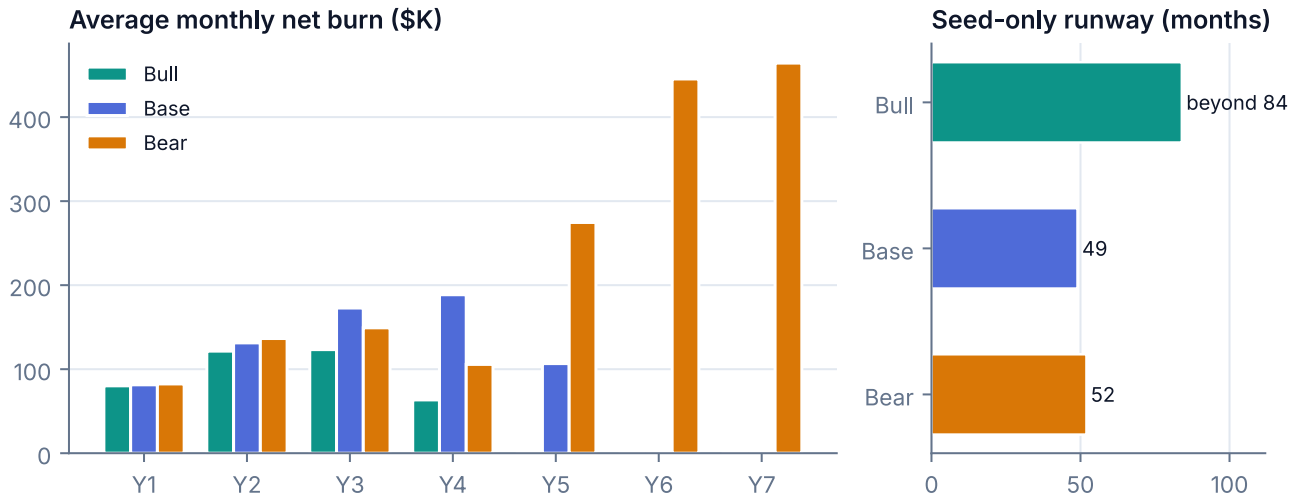


Figure 1: Average monthly net burn by year and seed-only runway (both tranches) in the three cases; the bull bar is drawn at the 84-month model horizon. Source: financial/tools/verify_results.json § Cash Flow|burn, Cash Flow|runway; checked against financial/budget.md § Net burn by year and financial/scenarios.md § Headline comparison

What each line contains

Engineering ($258.0K). Two software engineers from Q2 at a loaded $126.0K a year each, and one ML / data engineer from Q3 at $137.8K. Norwegian pay is the Statistics Norway average for information and communication (NOK 969,240 a year) times a 1.22 employer loading, converted at 9.3817 NOK per USD. The ML premium is assumed. Q1 has no engineering payroll because the founder builds through the first quarter while hiring.

Security ($223.4K). A security engineer from Q2 ($137.8K loaded) and a $120K security programme spread evenly: the first external penetration test, SOC 2 readiness work, tooling and insurance. The earlier use-of-funds plan put an independent security audit first, and the internal pre-audit found real defects (a ReDoS vector, missing tenant isolation, input-validation gaps), so security is the first non-payroll line we fund.

Sales ($60.0K). Travel to US design partners and freight-industry meetings only. No sales hire until year 2; the founder sells.

Marketing ($30.0K). Programmes only: content, list data and one trade-show presence. No marketing hire until year 3. Digital-marketing channel costs, when they arrive, will be checked against this line.

G&A ($356.0K). Founder pay ($156.1K loaded; NOK 1.2M assumed, held below market until Series A), legal and regulatory ($150K: US entity, customer contracts, FMC and data-protection counsel) and office, software, admin and accounting ($50K).

Claims operations ($97.8K, cost of revenue). One US claims analyst from Q3 ($100K loaded: $70K wage / 0.70), hosting, data feeds and tooling ($45K) and variable cost (8% of revenue, $2.8K).

Source: Statistics Norway, Earnings, https://www.ssb.no/arbeid-og-lonn/lonn-og-arbeidskraftkostnader/statistikk/lonn, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Norges Bank, Exchange rates USD/NOK monthly (Sep 2026 average 9.3817), https://data.norges-bank.no/api/data/EXR/M.USD.NOK.SP, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Employer Costs for Employee Compensation June 2026 (benefits 30.0%), https://www.bls.gov/news.release/ecec.nr0.htm, accessed 2026-10-17

Hiring plan, year 1

Role	Start	Loaded cost per year	Year-1 cost
Founder / CEO	Q1	$156.1K	$156.1K
Software engineer x 2	Q2	$126.0K each	$189.1K
Security engineer	Q2	$137.8K	$103.4K
ML / data engineer	Q3	$137.8K	$68.9K
Claims analyst (US)	Q3	$100.0K	$50.0K
Total, 6 people			**$567.4K**

People cost is 55% of year-1 spend. The remaining $457.8K is programmes and services.

Controls

The budget is released in two parts. Tranche 1 of the seed ($4.0M) funds years 1 and 2 on its own and, without tranche 2, runs out around month 32 (cumulative free cash flow is -$2,552.3K at the end of year 2 and year 3 burns $2,073.6K, so 24 + 12 x ($4,000K - $2,552.3K) / $2,073.6K = 32.4). Tranche 2 ($3.0M) is released when five customers pay, recovery is measured on real invoices and ARR passes $0.5M. If that milestone slips, the plan holds headcount and spending at year-2 levels (the bear-case response in `scenarios.md`). Any change to these figures should be made on the Assumptions tab of `model.xlsx`; the budget table above is a formula output and recalculates.

Use of funds

Date: 2026-10-17. Status: draft for owner review. Model: `financial/model.xlsx`, tab Cash Flow (funding requirement and use-of-seed sections). Base case unless stated. The company, scoup.ai, is pre-product with no revenue; the amounts below are sized from the operating plan, not from a target valuation.

The raise

We are raising a **$7.0M seed in two tranches**, and we plan a **$8.5M Series A** once ARR reaches $2.5M.

Round	Amount	Timing	Condition
Seed, tranche 1	$4.0M	At close	-
Seed, tranche 2	$3.0M	Base case around month 23	Five paying customers, recovery measured on real invoices, ARR above $0.5M
Series A	$8.5M	Milestone month 38 in the base case, close by about month 44	ARR of $2.5M

The seed size follows from the model. The deepest point of the base-case cash curve before a Series A arriving mid-way through year 4 is $5.76M: cumulative free cash flow is -$4,625.9K at the end of year 3, and half of the year-4 free cash flow (-$2,263.3K / 2 = -$1,131.7K) brings it to -$5,757.6K. With the 20% buffer that is $6.91M, which we round up to $7.0M. The figure includes the explicit segment mix the owner set on 2026-10-17 (shippers and SME importers first, carriers later through a partner). The investor-pack plan asked for $7.5M; the difference comes from removing costs it counted twice and from re-pricing Norwegian salaries at today's exchange rate (`audit.md`, changes C1, C2 and C7).

With both tranches and no Series A, the seed lasts **49 months** in the base case. The Series A milestone falls in month 38, so the seed leaves about six months to close the round plus a further six months of margin. Tranche 1 alone lasts about 32 months.

For orientation only: at the Q1 2026 median US seed pre-money valuation of $18.4M (PitchBook via WaveUp, grade C, not re-verified), $7.0M would buy 7.0 / (18.4 + 7.0) = 27.6% of the company before any option pool. Our round is more than twice the $3.0M median seed in the same source, so the median price may not apply. Terms are for the lead investor.

Where the seed goes

The table covers years 1 to 3, the period the seed funds before the Series A year. Revenue of $1.8M in the same period covers part of the gross uses, so the seed is drawn down by the net figure.

Use	$K	Share of gross uses
Engineering (software, ML / data)	1,498.0	23.2%
G&A (founder, finance and legal operations, counsel, office)	1,340.4	20.8%
Sales (account executives from year 2, sales engineer, travel, partner commission)	1,224.8	19.0%
Cost of revenue (claims analysts, hosting and data, variable cost)	941.9	14.6%
Security (engineer, pen tests, SOC 2, insurance)	835.8	12.9%
Marketing (hire from year 3, programmes)	401.1	6.2%
Working capital (receivables less payables)	157.1	2.4%
Equipment	57.0	0.9%

Use	$K	Share of gross uses
Gross uses	**6,456.0**	100%
Less revenue earned, years 1-3	-1,830.1	
Net use of cash, years 1-3	**4,625.9**	
Seed raised	7,000.0	
Remaining at the start of year 4	**2,374.1**	covers about half of year-4 burn plus the buffer

The order of priority is the one the earlier use-of-funds plan set, and it still holds: independent security verification and counsel before any real customer data, then design-partner validation, then product hardening and integrations, then go-to-market. In the model this shows as a security engineer and a $120K security programme in year 1, before any sales hire.

Milestones per tranche

Tranche 1 ($4.0M, months 0 to about 23) buys evidence.

1. External penetration test passed and SOC 2 readiness work under way before the first real customer file is loaded.
2. A gold evaluation set of 100+ realistic detention, demurrage and fuel-surcharge cases with known answers, and a measured pass rate on it (business-plan gate G0 and G2).
3. Three to five design partners (mid-market shippers and SME importers) sharing closed historical invoices under NDA, with recoverable dollars measured on their files (gate G1). This replaces the assumed $52K recovered per account.
4. The first paying contingency accounts, human-approved, with recovery rate, time per claim and analyst minutes per claim recorded (gate G3).

Tranche 2 ($3.0M, from about month 23 to the Series A) buys repeatability. It is released when five customers pay, recovery is measured on real invoices and ARR passes $0.5M. The base case crosses $0.5M ARR around month 23: 12 + 12 x ($500K - $69.0K) / ($562.1K - $69.0K) = 22.5. We also ask that acquisition cost on the first ten deals be measured and reported, because the plan spends $0.73 of sales and marketing per $1 of new direct ARR, which is far below the $2.00 benchmark (`unit-economics.md`). The money funds the first US account executive and sales engineer, more claims analysts, the platform-fee pricing and the search for a carrier channel partner (carriers start in year 3 in the base case).

Series A ($8.5M) buys scale. At $2.5M ARR the plan adds account executives (to nine by year 7), claims staff (to sixteen) and integrations with TMS, ELD and carrier tracking. The base case needs only $2.8M of further equity after the seed (total seven-year need $9.80M including buffer, less $7.0M). We size the Series A at $8.5M because a 20% shortfall in direct accounts won raises the seven-year need to $13.86M, which $7.0M plus $8.5M covers. It does not cover acquisition at paid-media prices: at the $31K pessimistic CAC (Metadata 2026) the seven-year need is $18.67M, at the $2.00 benchmark it is $38.49M, and if every account were a carrier at $7,895 it would be $36.01M.

If the milestones are missed

The bear case wins about half the base accounts, earns 20% less per account and churns 30% a year. Its ARR at the end of year 2 is $238K, so it never triggers tranche 2. On tranche 1 alone, with headcount held at year-2 levels from year 3, cash runs out around month 33. The bear case reaches the Series A milestone only

in month 57. The decision at the tranche-2 checkpoint is therefore a real one: either the measured recoveries and acquisition costs support the plan, or we stop or pivot with roughly a year of tranche-1 money left. This matches the kill triggers in `business/business-plan.md` section 6.

What changed from earlier versions

The five-year plan (`financial/model/06_use_of_proceeds.csv`) split a $2.5M seed by fixed percentages (security 15%, legal 10%, validation 20%, engineering 35%, go-to-market 10%, reserve 10%) without a cost plan behind it. The investor-pack plan sized a $7.5M seed from its workbook but typed the dollar amounts by function into the sheet. Here every figure above is a formula output of `model.xlsx`; change an input and this table recalculates.

Scenarios: bull, base and bear over seven years

Date: 2026-10-17 (revised for the owner decision on segments). Status: draft for owner review. Model: `financial/model.xlsx`, tab Scenarios (all three computed side by side) and every main tab (set Assumptions!B5 to 1, 2 or 3). Year 1 is the first twelve months after the seed closes.

These are plans for a company with no customers yet. On 2026-10-17 the owner decided that scoup.ai is shipper- and importer-first, with carriers as a later, partner-led channel. The model now shows that mix explicitly. Each segment has its own revenue per account: an SME importer follows the investor-pack path ($52K recovered in year 1, 25% share, platform fee from year 2), a mid-market shipper recovers 77% of the importer amount because it has no ocean demurrage and detention, and a carrier pays a flat $7,895 a year (the market-researcher carrier fee) through a channel partner that takes a 20% commission. New direct accounts split 50/50 between shippers and importers.

The three cases share the product, the pricing structure, the segment definitions and the cost lines. They differ only in the scenario inputs below.

What differs between the cases

Scenario input	Bull	Base	Bear
New shipper + importer accounts, Y1..Y7	8, 40, 100, 160, 215, 260, 300	6, 30, 75, 120, 165, 200, 235	4, 16, 35, 55, 75, 90, 105
New carrier accounts via partner, Y1..Y7	0, 10, 30, 60, 90, 120, 150	0, 0, 15, 30, 50, 70, 90	0, 0, 0, 0, 10, 20, 30
Annual logo churn (all segments)	15%	20%	30%
Revenue per account vs base path (all segments)	x 1.15	x 1.00	x 0.80
Headcount and spend scale	x 1.10	x 1.00	x 0.85
Variable cost of revenue	7% of revenue	8%	10%
Hold on hiring and spend	none	none	years 3-4 at year-2 level

In the base case design partners convert, importers add the container-fee and fuel checks and a factoring partner brings carriers from year 3. In the bull case the partner signs in year 2, customers accept the platform fee early and importers extend checks across their whole network. In the bear case recoveries run 20% below plan, buyers insist on long security reviews, the carrier partner slips to year 5, and management freezes hiring for two years.

Headline comparison

Output	Bull	Base	Bear
Revenue Y1 / Y3 / Y5 / Y7 ($M)	0.05 / 2.41 / 12.14 / 27.92	0.03 / 1.46 / 7.44 / 16.91	0.02 / 0.53 / 2.37 / 5.13
Revenue mix in Y7 (shippers / importers / carriers)	42% / 47% / 10%	44% / 48% / 8%	45% / 50% / 5%
Accounts at end of Y7 (shippers / importers / carriers)	424 / 423 / 374	304 / 301 / 200	118 / 116 / 49
ARR at end of Y7 ($M)	31.85	19.25	5.78
Gross margin Y7	84%	79%	52%
First EBITDA-positive year	Y5 (+$2.93M)	Y6 (+$1.23M)	not within 7 years
Month ARR reaches $2.5M (Series A milestone)	31	38	57
Seed need incl. 20% buffer ($M)	5.14	6.91	6.06

Output	Bull	Base	Bear
Seven-year equity need incl. buffer ($M)	5.59	9.80	23.88
Average monthly net burn Y1 / Y2 / Y3 / Y4 ($K)	80 / 122 / 123 / 63	81 / 131 / 173 / 189	82 / 137 / 149 / 106
Seed-only runway, both tranches (months)	beyond 84	49	52
Lowest year-end cash with $7.0M seed + $8.5M Series A ($M)	3.04	2.37	-4.40 (Y7)

The bear case would not receive tranche 2 (its year-2 ARR is $238K, below the $500K trigger); on tranche 1 alone its cash runs out around month 33. It also reaches the Series A milestone only in month 57, so the bear figure for lowest cash assumes rounds it would not get and still goes negative.

Base case ($M unless stated)

	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5	Y6	Y7
New accounts: shippers	3	15	38	60	83	100	118
New accounts: SME importers	3	15	37	60	82	100	117
New accounts: carriers (partner)	0	0	15	30	50	70	90
Accounts at year end: shippers	3	17	52	102	165	232	304
Accounts at year end: SME importers	3	17	51	101	163	230	301
Accounts at year end: carriers	0	0	15	42	84	137	200
Accounts at year end: total	6	34	118	245	412	599	805
Revenue per account: shipper ($K)	10.0	15.2	19.2	21.8	24.7	26.2	27.6
Revenue per account: importer ($K)	13.0	17.9	21.9	24.4	27.6	29.2	30.8
Revenue per account: carrier ($K)	7.9	7.9	7.9	7.9	7.9	7.9	7.9
Revenue: shippers	0.02	0.15	0.66	1.68	3.30	5.19	7.40
Revenue: SME importers	0.02	0.18	0.74	1.85	3.64	5.74	8.18
Revenue: carriers	0.00	0.00	0.06	0.23	0.50	0.87	1.33
Revenue: total	0.03	0.33	1.46	3.76	7.44	11.80	16.91
ARR, year end	0.07	0.56	2.23	5.02	9.24	13.87	19.25
Gross margin	-183%	21%	60%	70%	75%	77%	79%
Operating expense	0.93	1.59	2.78	4.51	6.25	7.86	9.24
EBITDA	-0.99	-1.53	-1.89	-1.90	-0.70	1.23	4.05
Net income	-1.00	-1.54	-1.91	-1.92	-0.73	1.20	4.03
Free cash flow	-0.98	-1.58	-2.07	-2.26	-1.28	0.54	3.25
Cash, year end (with planned rounds)	3.02	4.45	2.37	8.61	7.33	7.87	11.12
Headcount, year end	6	11	19	31	39	49	54



Figure 2: Base-case revenue and accounts at year end by segment, years 1 to 7. Source: financial/tools/verify_results.json § base (recomputed financial/model.xlsx); checked against financial/scenarios.md § Base case

Bull case ($M unless stated)

	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5	Y6	Y7
New accounts: shippers	4	20	50	80	108	130	150
New accounts: SME importers	4	20	50	80	107	130	150
New accounts: carriers (partner)	0	10	30	60	90	120	150
Accounts at year end: shippers	4	23	70	139	226	322	424
Accounts at year end: SME importers	4	23	70	139	225	321	423
Accounts at year end: carriers	0	10	38	92	168	263	374
Accounts at year end: total	8	56	178	370	619	906	1,221
Revenue per account: shipper ($K)	11.5	17.4	22.0	25.0	28.4	30.1	31.8
Revenue per account: importer ($K)	14.9	20.6	25.2	28.1	31.7	33.6	35.4
Revenue per account: carrier ($K)	9.1	9.1	9.1	9.1	9.1	9.1	9.1
Revenue: shippers	0.02	0.24	1.02	2.62	5.18	8.24	11.85
Revenue: SME importers	0.03	0.28	1.17	2.93	5.78	9.17	13.18
Revenue: carriers	0.00	0.05	0.22	0.59	1.18	1.96	2.89
Revenue: total	0.05	0.56	2.41	6.14	12.14	19.37	27.92
ARR, year end	0.11	0.97	3.65	8.22	15.09	22.86	31.85
Gross margin	-86%	49%	73%	78%	81%	83%	84%
Operating expense	0.93	1.66	2.95	4.96	6.92	8.64	10.15
EBITDA	-0.97	-1.38	-1.19	-0.16	2.93	7.44	13.31
Net income	-0.98	-1.39	-1.21	-0.19	2.89	5.97	10.37
Free cash flow	-0.96	-1.46	-1.48	-0.76	1.98	4.86	9.05
Cash, year end (with planned rounds)	3.04	4.58	3.10	10.84	12.82	17.69	26.73
Headcount, year end	6	11	20	34	42	52	58

Bear case ($M unless stated)

	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5	Y6	Y7
New accounts: shippers	2	8	18	28	38	45	53

	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5	Y6	Y7
New accounts: SME importers	2	8	17	27	37	45	52
New accounts: carriers (partner)	0	0	0	0	10	20	30
Accounts at year end: shippers	2	9	24	45	69	93	118
Accounts at year end: SME importers	2	9	23	43	67	92	116
Accounts at year end: carriers	0	0	0	0	10	27	49
Accounts at year end: total	4	18	47	88	146	212	283
Revenue per account: shipper ($K)	8.0	12.1	15.3	17.4	19.8	20.9	22.1
Revenue per account: importer ($K)	10.4	14.3	17.5	19.5	22.1	23.4	24.6
Revenue per account: carrier ($K)	6.3	6.3	6.3	6.3	6.3	6.3	6.3
Revenue: shippers	0.01	0.07	0.25	0.60	1.13	1.70	2.33
Revenue: SME importers	0.01	0.08	0.28	0.64	1.21	1.86	2.56
Revenue: carriers	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.03	0.12	0.24
Revenue: total	0.02	0.15	0.53	1.25	2.37	3.67	5.13
ARR, year end	0.04	0.24	0.77	1.62	2.91	4.27	5.78
Gross margin	-426%	-64%	37%	66%	52%	48%	52%
Operating expense	0.93	1.52	1.93	1.98	4.34	6.91	8.02
EBITDA	-1.01	-1.61	-1.73	-1.16	-3.11	-5.14	-5.34
Net income	-1.01	-1.62	-1.74	-1.16	-3.13	-5.17	-5.38
Free cash flow	-0.99	-1.64	-1.79	-1.27	-3.30	-5.34	-5.57
Cash, year end (with planned rounds)	3.01	4.37	2.58	9.81	6.52	1.17	-4.40
Headcount, year end	6	11	11	11	36	43	48

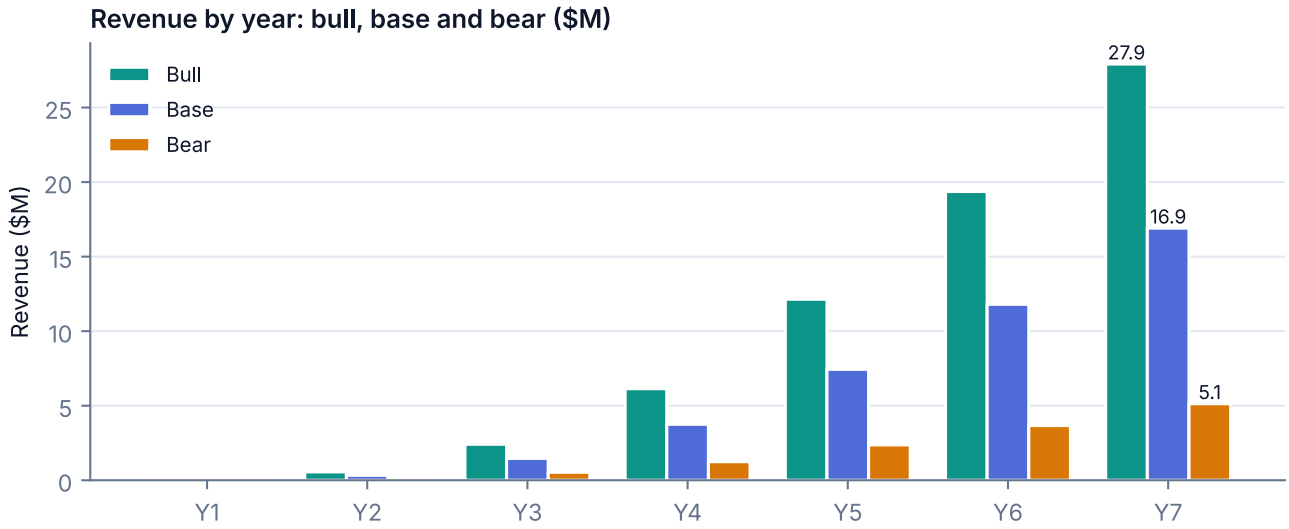


Figure 3: Revenue by year in the bull, base and bear cases. Source: financial/tools/verify_results.json § bull, base, bear; checked against financial/scenarios.md § Bull case, Base case, Bear case and § Headline comparison

Reading the cases

Base. Revenue grows from $35K in year 1 to $16.9M in year 7 on 805 accounts: 304 shippers, 301 SME importers and 200 carriers. Importers earn the most per account ($30.8K in year 7), shippers $27.6K, carriers $7.9K, so carriers are a quarter of accounts but 8% of revenue. ARR crosses the $2.5M Series A bar in month 38 and EBITDA turns positive in year 6. The cash low point before the Series A is the end of year 3, at $2.37M

with the $7.0M seed. Gross margin starts deeply negative because one claims analyst and the hosting bill arrive before revenue, passes 60% in year 3 and reaches 79% in year 7, close to the 77% Benchmarkit median for B2B software.

Bull. Higher recoveries, lower churn and a carrier partner in year 2 bring the milestone forward to month 31 and EBITDA break-even to year 5. The $7.0M seed alone would fund this case to profitability (seven-year need $5.59M including buffer), so the Series A becomes optional growth capital. Tax starts in year 6 once accumulated losses are used up.

Bear. Half the direct account wins, 20% lower revenue per account and 30% churn leave ARR at $771K after year 3 and $5.8M after year 7. The two-year hiring hold keeps the company at eleven people in years 3 and 4; when the hold ends, the scaled plan resumes, costs outrun revenue and EBITDA falls to -$5.34M by year 7. This is not a venture business. It shows what the tranche-2 checkpoint protects against: if measured recoveries and acquisition costs look like this at month 22, we stop or pivot with tranche-1 money left. A permanent hold instead reaches break-even in year 6, but only with two claims analysts and two salespeople serving the whole customer base, which we do not consider credible.

Sensitivities on the base case

Each row changes one input group, rebuilds the workbook and recomputes it (`financial/tools/verify_model.py`, results in `tools/verify_results.json`).

Change from base	Seed need incl. buffer ($M)	Seven-year equity need ($M)	Milestone month	Lowest year-end cash ($M)	Year-7 EBITDA ($M)
None (base)	6.91	9.80	38	2.37	4.05
New shipper + importer accounts -20% every year	7.59	13.86	40	2.10	1.19
Revenue per account -20% (all segments)	7.62	14.12	40	2.09	0.99
CAC $31K on direct accounts (Metadata 2026 paid-media cost per small-company customer)	9.98	18.67	38	-0.06	1.12
Sales and marketing at the $2.00 benchmark per $1 of new direct ARR	11.86	38.49	38	-16.58	-5.32
All carrier: every account (same total count) is a carrier at $7,895	9.34	36.01	54	-14.51	-7.26

Account wins and revenue per account matter about equally: a 20% shortfall in either adds about $0.7M to the seed need, $4.1-4.3M to the seven-year need and two months to the milestone. Acquisition cost matters more. At the sourced pessimistic $31K CAC the plan needs $18.7M of equity and breaks even only in year 7; at the $2.00 benchmark efficiency it needs $38.5M and never breaks even. The all-carrier row is the downside the owner decision removes from the base case: with the same number of accounts, all at carrier economics, year-7 ARR is $6.3M and the business does not work.

Market size and share of SAM

Market-researcher sized the market for the shipper- and importer-first plan in `research/05-market-size.md` v3 (2026-10-17), which supersedes its earlier $474.2M SAM and $10.30B TAM.

- **SAM: 32,765 accounts, $945.4M a year.** 19,932 mid-market shippers (US Census SUSB 2022 firms with $100M-$999.9M of receipts in manufacturing, wholesale and retail, which at a 4.68% transport-to-sales ratio means $5M-$50M of freight spend) plus 12,833 SME importers (the FMC demurrage and detention pool of $3.08B a year divided by the $240K exposure we model). The dollar figure uses our

year-7 segment rates: 19,932 x $27.6K = $550.1M for shippers plus 12,833 x $30.8K = $395.3M for importers. If every importer were also counted as a shipper, the pool would be as low as $550.1M; the overlap is unknown.

- **TAM: 133,256 accounts, $1,855.5M.** The SAM plus 72,053 carriers at $7,895 (5-100 trucks, the later partner channel) and 28,438 brokers at an assumed $12K.

Share in year 7	Bull	Base	Bear
Shipper + importer accounts / 32,765 SAM accounts	847 = 2.6%	605 = 1.8%	234 = 0.7%
Shipper + importer revenue / $945.4M SAM	2.6%	1.6%	0.5%
Shippers / 19,932	2.1%	1.5%	0.6%
SME importers / 12,833	3.3%	2.3%	0.9%
Carriers / 72,053	0.5%	0.3%	0.1%
Shipper revenue / $550.1M shipper SAM	2.2%	1.3%	0.4%
Importer revenue / $395.3M importer SAM	3.3%	2.1%	0.6%

The 12,833 importers are sized at about $36K of D&D recovery each, the mid-size importers our revenue path assumes, so the earlier concern (importer revenue at 44% of a smaller importer pool) no longer applies. A 1.8% share of SAM accounts after seven years is an ambitious but not implausible plan for a new vendor, and the market does not cap any case. The shipper count rests on a 2008 transport-to-sales survey; at 2% or 10% instead of 4.68% the shipper count is 9,366 or 35,349 (research sensitivity), which would put base year-7 shippers at 3.2% or 0.9% of their segment. Market-researcher also estimates an average mid-market shipper with $9.53M of freight spend recovers $95.3K a year at a 1% recoverable rate (assumed), inside our recovery path of $85K-$115K, which supports the shipper revenue per account.

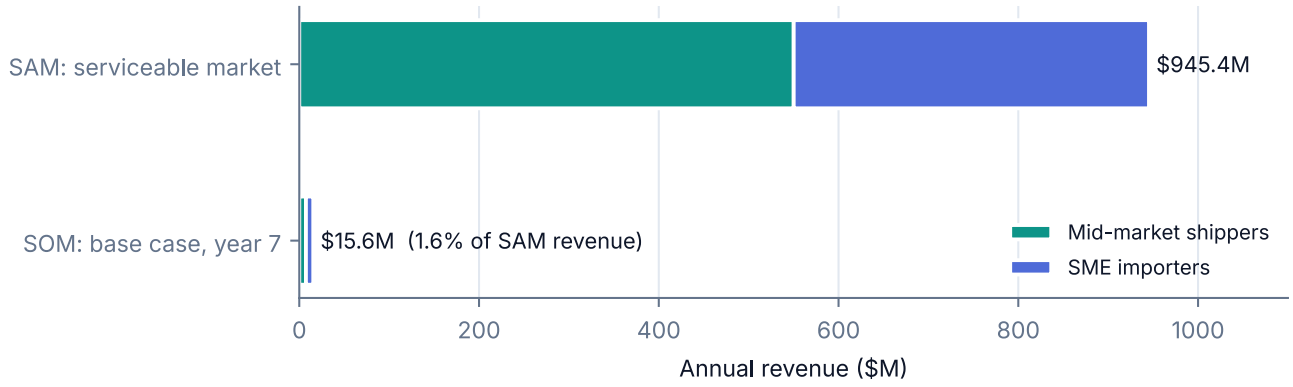


Figure 4: Serviceable market (SAM) against obtainable base-case revenue in year 7 (SOM), split by core segment. Source: research/05-market-size.md § 4. TAM, SAM, SOM; SOM from financial/tools/verify_results.json § base, checked against the same section

Open questions

1. **Shipper count basis.** The 19,932 mid-market shippers depend on a 2008 transport-to-sales ratio (4.68%); a current figure would firm up the SAM.
2. **Shipper and importer overlap.** Some firms are both; the SAM could be as low as $550.1M (shippers only) because the overlap is unknown.
3. **Importer size.** The 12,833 importers are the FMC-pool cap and sit inside a public bound of 4,160-20,279 importers with roughly $17M-$169M of annual imports (Census 2024 importer counts, BTS and S&P container data, per market-researcher). A 2,000-TEU importer (about $67.5M of imports) is closer to a Census large (500+ employees) importer than a typical SME; an exact count needs bill-of-lading data.
4. **Competitor pricing.** None published; fee path stays assumed until pilots test it.

5. **Shipper recovery.** The 0.77 multiplier rests on an assumed $24K of accessorial and detention audit recovery per shipper.
6. **Bear-case response** (two-year hold, permanent hold or stop) is an owner decision.
7. **Entity.** Whether US staff sit in the Norwegian AS or a Delaware subsidiary affects payroll taxes and the 22% tax rate.

Financial model audit

Date: 2026-10-17. Author: finance agent, for Marius Carlsson. Status: draft for owner review.

The company, scoup.ai, is pre-product. We have no customers, no revenue and no measured recovery rate, and every figure in the files we audited is a plan input or the arithmetic consequence of one. This audit covers the existing financial material in the main checkout (read-only), records what is sourced and what is assumed, lists hardcoded values that should be formulas, and lists every inconsistency we found between the files. The last section records the formula-drivenness check on the new `financial/model.xlsx`.

1. Files audited

#	File	Date on disk	What it is
F1	`financial/model.md`	2026-10-05	Five-year detention-only model, $40K ACV, $2.0-3.0M seed
F2	`financial/model/01_assumptions.csv` to `09_burn_runway.csv`	2026-10-08	Tabular copy of F1
F3	`financial/model/freight-recovery-financial-model.xlsx`	2026-10-08	Nine tabs, text copy of F2
F4	`business/investor-pack/scoup-financial-model.xlsx`	2026-10-12	Seven-year, three-scenario model, $7.5M seed, live formulas
F5	`business/investor-pack/02-scoup-financial-plan.pdf`	2026-10-12	Narrative of F4 (text extracted with pypdf)
F6	`business/investor-brief.md`	before 2026-10-12	Investment memorandum; still uses F1 numbers and the old name Freight Recovery
F7	`business/business-plan.md`	2026-10-05	Business plan with F1 numbers
F8	`business/business-case-2026-10-cost-intelligence.md`	2026-10-11	Source of the F4 revenue-per-account build

The pricing model is contingency in every file: a share of dollars actually recovered, nothing if nothing is recovered. F1, F6 and F7 use 20%. F8 and F4 use 25% in the pilot year, then a platform fee plus a lower share (17% falling to 12%). The product code in `freight-recovery-build` holds no pricing logic, so the documents are the only source.

The two generations of material describe different businesses. F1, F2, F3, F6 and F7 model a detention and accessorial recovery tool with a $40K contract value and a $2.0-3.0M seed. F4 and F5, written a week later, model a broader cost-recovery product (ocean demurrage and detention audit, fuel-surcharge verification, detention) with revenue per account of $13K rising to $31K and a $7.5M seed. F4 is the more rigorous of the two, so we reused it as the base; section 4 lists every number that differs.

2. Inputs: sourced or assumed

2.1 F1, F2 and F3 (detention-only model)

No input in F1-F3 carries a URL. F7 states that the ATRI primary PDF had not been opened and that live search was unavailable when it was written. In practice everything below is an assumption.

Input	Value	Status	Note
Example shipper freight spend	$20M	Assumed	"Mid-market band", no source

Input	Value	Status	Note
Recoverable share of spend	1.0% (bull 1.3%, bear 0.75%)	Assumed	Audit-vendor claim of 1-3% cited as grade C, no link
Contingency fee	20%	Assumed	"15-30% typical per vendors", grade C, no link
ACV	$40K (bull $55K, bear $30K)	Derived for base; bull and bear set by hand	Base = $20M x 1.0% x 20%. Bull $55K does not follow from $20M x 1.3% x 20% = $52K
Gross margin	60% rising to 70%	Assumed	ICONIQ via SaaStr cited, no link
Blended CAC	$25K (bull $22K, bear $30K)	Assumed	No source
Logo churn	20% (bull 15%, bear 35%)	Assumed	No source
Loaded headcount cost	$150K	Assumed	No source
Year-end paying accounts	5 / 25 / 80 / 180 / 330	Assumed	Plan input
Valuation multiples	8-15x ARR, haircut 4-6x	Assumed	Clouded Judgement 4.1x and 12.4x cited as grade A, no link
Series A and dilution medians	$14.4M at $80M post, 18%	Secondary	"Carta via secondary", no link
CAC payback benchmark	18-20 months	Secondary	KeyBanc / Benchmarkit, no link
Use of proceeds split	15 / 10 / 20 / 35 / 10 / 10%	Assumed	Not derived from a cost plan
Cap table	$2.5M at $10M post, 12.5% pool	Assumed	No source

2.2 F4 and F5 (seven-year model)

Input	F4 value	Status	Re-verification on 2026-10-17
Compensation inflation	4%/yr	Assumed	n/a
Series A ARR milestone	$2.5M	Assumed, Carta median $2.8M as context	Direct fetch of carta.com returned HTTP 403; the $2.8M (2025, up from $2.3M in 2024) figure appears in carta.com search results
Cash buffer on each round	20%	Assumed	n/a
Months to close next round	6	Assumed	n/a
NOK per USD	10.5	Assumed	Live rate differs: Norges Bank Sep 2026 average 9.3817. Live source wins (change C2)
Platform fee	$0-17K/yr	Assumed	Competitor pricing pending from market-researcher
Amount recovered per account	$52K-115K/yr	Derived in F8 from FMC, EIA and ATRI figures	F8 itself flags the FMC $15.4B figure as not re-verified
Recovery share	25% to 12%	Assumed, Refund Retriever 40-50% as context	Refund Retriever publishes 50% / 45% / 40% by shipping volume: confirmed
Software engineer pay	NOK ~969K x 1.22	Sourced (SSB)	SSB Nov 2025 information and communication average NOK 80,770/month = NOK 969,240/yr: confirmed
Employer social security	14.1%	Sourced (Skatteetaten)	Zone I 14.1% for 2026: confirmed
Loading factor 1.22		Partly sourced	14.1% sourced; the remaining ~8 points are assumed

Input	F4 value	Status	Re-verification on 2026-10-17
ML, security, finance pay	$125K, $125K, $130K loaded	Assumed premium over SSB	n/a
US sales engineer	$175K loaded	Sourced (BLS)	Median $124,900 (May 2025): confirmed; x 1.43 = $178.4K, not $175K
US benefits loading	x 1.43	Sourced (BLS ECEC)	June 2026: benefits 30.0% of private-industry compensation: confirmed
Account executive	$230K loaded	Assumed	Stated basis "BLS base $105K, OTE ~2x, loaded" gives $105K x 2 x 1.43 = $300K, so $230K does not follow from its own rule. Not re-verified
Claims analyst	$100K loaded	Assumed	n/a
Headcount plan	6 to 54 people	Assumed	n/a
Other operating costs	six lines	Assumed (grade C)	SOC 2 and pen-test cost ranges come from vendor blogs; not re-verified
New accounts per year	6 to 235 (base)	Assumed	n/a
Churn	20% (15% / 30%)	Assumed, Benchmarkit GRR 88% as context	GRR 88%: confirmed
Gross margin path	50% to 74% (base)	Assumed	Replaced by a bottom-up cost of revenue (change C1)
S&M per $1 of new ARR benchmark	$2.00	Sourced (Benchmarkit)	2024 median New CAC Ratio $2.00: confirmed
Seed median	$3.0M at $18.4M pre	Sourced, grade C	Not re-verified

Source: Norges Bank, Exchange rates USD/NOK monthly, https://data.norges-bank.no/api/data/EXR/M.USD.NOK.SP, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Statistics Norway, Earnings, https://www.ssb.no/arbeid-og-lonn/lonn-og-arbeidskraftkostnader/statistikk/lonn, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Skatteetaten, Arbeidsgiveravgift rates, https://www.skatteetaten.no/satser/arbeidsgiveravgift/, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook: Sales Engineers, https://www.bls.gov/ooh/sales/sales-engineers.htm, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Employer Costs for Employee Compensation June 2026, https://www.bls.gov/news.release/ecec.nr0.htm, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Benchmarkit, 2025 SaaS Performance Metrics, https://www.benchmarkit.ai/2025benchmarks, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Refund Retriever, Pricing, https://www.refundretriever.com/pricing, accessed 2026-10-17 Source: Carta, ARR at Series A, https://carta.com/data/newsletter-arr-at-series-a/, accessed 2026-10-17 (via search result)

3. Hardcoded values that should be formulas

F3 is not a working model. All of its cells are text: 0 numeric cells, 0 live formulas, and the three cells that look like formulas on `unit_economics` (C3 `= 20M x 1.0%`, C4 `= recoverable x 20% = ACV`, C10 `= 26K / 0.20`) are text strings. Every figure in it would have to be retyped by hand after any change to an assumption.

F4 is formula-driven at its core (867 formulas) but still holds inputs and results in the wrong places:

Location in F4	Hardcoded value	Should be
Base, Upside, Downside B5:H5	New accounts per year	Inputs on Assumptions, so all scenario levers sit in one place
Base, Upside, Downside B6, B7, B8	Churn, revenue multiplier, cost scale	Same
Base, Upside, Downside B12:H12	Gross margin per year	A bottom-up cost of revenue (it double-counts costs, see 4.2)

Location in F4	Hardcoded value	Should be
Base, Upside, Downside B17 and B24	`*0.6` inside every year-1 people-cost formula	An input: year-1 hiring quarter per role
Base, Upside, Downside B18	`*1` instead of the cost-scale cell in year 1	Explicit, documented choice (kept in the new model)
Financing B13, B14	Seed $7.5M, Series A $8.5M	Inputs feeding the cash flow, with a check that cash stays above zero
Financing D13, D14, A16	"Base need $7.36M", "month 55", "$7.6M" typed into text	Formula outputs
Use of funds B5:B11, B27:B33	Every dollar amount by function	SUMs of the cost lines over the funded period
Use of funds A3, A13, A25, A35	"$8.83M less $2.70M = $6.13M" typed into text	Formula outputs
Unit economics B13	$2.00 benchmark on a calculation tab	An Assumptions input
Customer value B6, B7, B9, B11	7,540; 12,670; 16,000; 36,000	Derivations of other cells (for example B11 = B10 x 15%)

F2 and F1 have no formulas at all. The derived lines (ACV, gross profit, LTV, LTV:CAC, revenue, run-rate, valuation) are typed numbers.

4. Inconsistencies

4.1 Between the five-year files (F1, F2, F3, F6, F7)

1. **Bull LTV.** F2 shows $180K. With ACV $55K, a 62-72% margin and 15% churn, LTV is $55K x 67% / 0.15 = $246K. $180K implies a 49% margin.
2. **Bear LTV.** F2 shows $74K, which is $26K / 0.35, i.e. the base-case gross profit. With the bear ACV of $30K and a 58.5% margin it is $30K x 58.5% / 0.35 = $50K.
3. **Bear LTV:CAC.** F1 and F7 say 3.0x "at 35% churn" (base CAC $25K: $74K / $25K = 2.96x); F2 says 2.5x (bear CAC $30K: $74K / $30K = 2.47x). Neither uses the bear ACV.
4. **Gross profit per account.** F2 row "Gross margin (blended Y1-2) 60%" sits above "Gross profit per account $26K at ~65%". At 60% the figure is $24K.
5. **Founder ownership after seed.** F2 shows 62.5% (from $2.5M at $10M post with a 12.5% pool); F6 says "near ~56% post-seed" from Carta medians.
6. **Name.** F6 and F7 use Freight Recovery; F4 and F5 use scoup.ai. The owner has set the name as lowercase scoup.ai.
7. **Stale technical statements in F6.** It describes a ~1,100-line Python/FastAPI MVP to be ported, which no longer matches the TypeScript platform in `freight-recovery-build`, and it states "~250x" mesh speed-ups from internal synthetic benchmarks next to financial claims. These are not finance inputs, but the honesty rule applies to them; flagged for the architect and the owner.

The F2 arithmetic that does hold: base revenue (Y1 2.5 x $40K x 0.5 = $0.05M; Y2 15 x $40K = $0.60M; Y5 255 x $40K = $10.2M), run-rates, use-of-proceeds total ($2.5M, 100%), cap table (25% at $10M post) and the valuation table ($13.2M x 8 = $106M, x 15 = $198M) all recompute correctly.

4.2 Inside the seven-year files (F4, F5)

1. **Cost of revenue is counted twice.** F4 computes cost of revenue as revenue x (1 - gross margin), and its note says the margin is "after hosting, data feeds and claim review labour". The same claims analysts (Assumptions row 26) and the same hosting and data line (row 32) are also inside People costs and Other operating costs. In base year 3 that double-counts about $0.46M: claims analysts (2 + 4) / 2 x $100K x 1.04^2 = $0.32M plus hosting $0.14M. F4 EBITDA is therefore too low by roughly that amount every year, and its seed and Series A sizes are too high. Fixed in the new model (change C1).

2. **The PDF downside table does not match the workbook.** F4 rounds scaled headcount with Excel ROUND (half away from zero). The F5 figures were evidently produced with round-half-to-even: downside year-5 headcount is 34 in F5 but 36 when the F4 formulas are evaluated (10 × 0.85 = 8.5 rounds to 9 in Excel, 8 in Python), and downside year-5 EBITDA is -$4.77M in F5 against -$4.90M from the workbook. Base and upside are unaffected because their scale factors do not produce .5 values.
3. **Sales efficiency is far better than the benchmark it cites.** F4 plans $0.68 of sales and marketing per $1 of new ARR in base year 3; the cited Benchmarkit 2024 median is $2.00. F5 calls this the largest single risk, which we agree with. At $2.00 the F5 text says LTV:CAC falls to 1.6x.
4. **Milestone month.** F5 says the base case reaches $2.5M ARR "around month 37". Interpolating F4 year-end ARR ($2.256M at month 36, $4.929M at month 48) gives 36 + 12 x (2.5 - 2.256) / (4.929 - 2.256) = month 37.1, so the first full month above the milestone is month 38.
5. **Account-executive cost** does not follow its stated rule (section 2.2).
6. **Missing statements.** F4 stops at EBITDA. It has no tax, depreciation, working capital, cash flow statement or balance sheet. Contingency fees are paid after the counterparty pays the customer, so receivables are a real cash use that F4 ignores.
7. **The downside cost response is described, not modelled.** F5 section 4 says hiring is held at year-2 levels if the tranche-2 milestone is missed and quotes the result ($7.6M, month 55). No formula in F4 implements the hold.

4.3 Between the generations, and against the new model

Metric	F1 / F2 / F6 / F7	F4 / F5	New `model.xlsx` (base)
Horizon	5 years	7 years	7 years
Product scope	Detention and accessorials	D&D audit, fuel surcharge, detention	As F4; segments explicit (shippers, SME importers, carriers via partner)
Revenue per account	$40K ACV	$13.0K (Y1) to $30.8K (Y7)	Importer as F4; shipper 77% of the importer recovery; carrier $7.9K
Year-5 revenue	$10.20M	$7.30M	$7.44M
Year-5 ARR / run-rate	$13.2M	$9.03M	$9.24M
Gross margin	60% to 70% (input)	50% to 74% (input)	-183% (Y1), 60% (Y3), 75% (Y5), 79% (Y7), output
CAC	$25K (input)	~$14.9K (Y3, implied)	$15.0K (Y3), $17.9K (Y5) on direct accounts, output
LTV:CAC	5.2x	4.7x (Y3)	4.1x (Y3), 5.4x (Y5); 2.0x / 3.1x at the $31K pessimistic CAC
First EBITDA-positive year	"between years 3 and 4" (F6 9.5)	Year 7	Year 6
Seed	$2.0-3.0M	$7.5M ($4.0M + $3.5M)	$7.0M ($4.0M + $3.0M)
Series A	~$10-14M (median reference)	$8.5M	$8.5M
Seed runway	~30 months at $2.5M	to ~month 43	49 months with both tranches, no Series A
Year-1 monthly burn	$75-85K	~$77K (EBITDA basis)	$81.4K (free-cash-flow basis)

F6 (the investor brief) still quotes the five-year numbers. Anyone reading F6 next to F5 sees a seed of $2.0-3.0M in one and $7.5M in the other, a $40K ACV in one and $13K-31K in the other, and break-even in year 3-4 against year 7. The investor package should carry one set of numbers; we recommend the owner retire F1-F3 and update F6 and F7 to the figures in `financial/scenarios.md`.

5. What we reused and what we changed

We kept F4 wherever it holds up: the revenue-per-account build (platform fee, amount recovered, recovery share), the three new-account plans, churn, revenue multipliers, cost scales, the headcount plan by role, the six other-cost lines, the 4% inflation, the 20% buffer and the $2.5M Series A milestone. Before change C14 the new model reproduced F4 base revenue and ARR to the dollar ($7,300.2K revenue and $9,025.2K ARR in year 5); C14 then made the segment mix explicit. Effects in rows C1-C11 are stated as of the first draft; C14 gives the current figures.

#	Change	Why	Effect (base case)
C1	Cost of revenue built bottom-up: claims-operations people + hosting and data + variable cost (new input, 8% of revenue). Claims staff and hosting removed from operating expense. Gross margin becomes an output.	F4 counted these costs twice (4.2 item 1).	Year-3 gross margin 61% (F4 64%); year-5 74% (F4 71%); EBITDA turns positive in year 6 instead of year 7
C2	NOK per USD 10.5 → 9.3817	Live Norges Bank rate wins over the repo figure (brief rule)	Norwegian loaded costs rise about 12%; software engineer $126.0K instead of $115K
C3	Norwegian pay entered in NOK and converted; US pay entered as wages / (1 - 0.30)	Makes the FX and benefits inputs actually drive cost	Sales engineer $178.4K instead of $175K; other US roles unchanged
C4	Year-1 hiring quarter per role replaces the `*0.6` factor	Hardcode removed; drives the quarterly budget	3.25 non-founder FTE-years in year 1 instead of 3.0
C5	Bear cost response modelled: hold headcount and spend at year-2 level for years 3-4, then resume the scaled plan	F5 described it, F4 did not model it	See `scenarios.md`
C6	Added tax (22%, loss carry-forward), depreciation, receivables (60 days), payables (30 days), cash flow statement and balance sheet	Required tabs; contingency revenue is collected late	Seed need $6.80M including buffer and half of the year-4 burn
C7	Seed $7.5M → $7.0M (tranche 1 $4.0M unchanged, tranche 2 $3.5M -> $3.0M)	Re-sized to the new model's need ($6.80M)	Base seed-only runway 50 months; lowest year-end cash $2.46M (year 3)
C8	Scenario names Upside/Downside → Bull/Bear; all scenario levers moved to Assumptions	Brief naming; one place for inputs	None on numbers
C9	Platform fee and recovery share relabelled ASSUMED (first draft: PENDING research)	Market-researcher found no competitor publishes pricing, so research cannot confirm them	None
C10	Addressable accounts set to 334,514 (carriers 5-100 trucks + SME importers + brokers)	Market-researcher counts (FMCSA, US Census); used only for the share-of-market check	Year-7 base accounts = 0.18% of the count
C12	SAM fee pool input $474.2M (`sam_usd`) and a Revenue row for revenue as a share of SAM	market-researcher 05-market-size.md	Base year-7 revenue = 3.5% of SAM (3.6% after C14)

#	Change	Why	Effect (base case)
C13	Carrier-economics sensitivity: every account at $7,895 a year	SAM is 96% carriers, the revenue build is importer-shipper	Seed need $9.16M, seven-year need $35.7M, no break-even. After C14 replaced by the all-carrier run (same account count, all carriers): $9.34M seed, $36.0M total
C14	Explicit segment mix (owner decision 2026-10-17): direct accounts split 50/50 between mid-market shippers (77% of the importer recovery, `shp_mult`) and SME importers (F4 path); carriers added as a separate partner-led segment from year 3 (base 0, 0, 15, 30, 50, 70, 90 new a year) at $7,895 each with a 20% partner commission booked in Sales. Unit economics now measured on direct accounts; carrier CAC = commission / new carriers. All-carrier run kept as a downside sensitivity	The prior model depended on an unstated mix; the market SAM is 96% carriers	Year-7 revenue $16.43M → $16.91M; accounts 605 → 805 (304 / 301 / 200); seed need $6.80M → $6.91M (raise stays $7.0M); runway 50 → 49 months; EBITDA positive year 6 unchanged; year-3 LTV : CAC 4.5x → 4.1x; all-carrier downside needs $36.0M of equity
C15	SAM inputs replaced with market-researcher v3 (2026-10-18 revision): `sam` 32,765 shipper + importer accounts, `sam_usd` $1,009.2M (shippers $613.9M + importers $395.3M); share-of-SAM rows now use shipper + importer accounts and revenue only. C10 and C12 values (334,514 accounts, $474.2M) are withdrawn by market-researcher	Shipper- and importer-first sizing; carriers and brokers belong to the TAM (133,256 accounts, $4.10B)	Base year-7 direct accounts = 1.8% of SAM accounts, revenue = 1.5% of the SAM pool; shipper revenue 1.2% of $613.9M, importer revenue 2.1% of $395.3M (the earlier 44%-of-importer-pool problem is resolved); no headline number changes
C16	SAM pool `sam_usd` $1,009.2M → $945.4M; TAM $4.10B → $1,855.5M (market-researcher final, 2026-10-18, at our year-7 segment rates: shippers $27.6K, importers $30.8K, carriers $7,895, brokers $12K assumed)	Market size and model now use the same revenue per account	Base year-7 direct revenue = 1.6% of SAM (was 1.5%); shippers 1.3% of $550.1M; importers 2.1% of $395.3M unchanged; account shares unchanged; no headline number changes
C11	Pessimistic CAC input $31K (Metadata 2026 paid-media cost per small-company customer) with LTV : CAC and payback rows	Digital-marketing showed the investor-brief funnel assumes about 6x the observed paid lead-to-customer rate	Year-3 LTV : CAC 2.2x at $31K; full-model seed need $9.86M (after C14: 2.0x and $9.98M)

The five-year model (F1-F3) is not reused. Its $40K ACV rests on a 1% recoverable share of a $20M freight spend that no source supports, and the product scope has since moved to the F8 build.

6. Formula-drivenness check (recorded 2026-10-17, re-run 2026-10-18 after C14)

`financial/tools/verify_model.py` runs these checks against `financial/model.xlsx`; results are in `financial/tools/verify_results.json`. The workbook is evaluated with the open-source `formulas` package (v1.3.4), so the check does not depend on Excel having cached values.

1. **No hardcoded numbers outside Assumptions.** Numeric constant cells on the eight non-Assumptions tabs: **0**. Formula cells: Revenue 254, Headcount 308, OpEx 254, P&L 140, Cash Flow 161, Balance Sheet 84, Unit Economics 161, Scenarios 1,478. Formulas contain only structural constants (12 months, 365 days, 4 quarters, 1000, 0.5 for a mid-year round).
2. **Balance sheet balances** in all seven years (check row = 0) for Base, Bull and Bear.
3. **The two engines agree.** The Scenarios tab recomputes all three scenarios independently; its active-scenario revenue, EBITDA, net income, free cash flow and closing cash equal the main tabs in every year (difference 0).
4. **The year-1 quarterly budget sums to the annual model** (difference 0).
5. **One assumption changed at a time, model rebuilt and recomputed:**

Change	P&L rows that moved	Example
Recovery share, year 3: 14% → 20%	Revenue, EBITDA, net income	Y3 revenue $1,464.9K → $1,773.8K; Y3 EBITDA -$1,894.6K → -$1,610.4K
Compensation inflation: 4% → 6%	EBITDA, net income	Y7 EBITDA $4,052.4K → $2,922.8K
NOK per USD: 9.3817 → 10.5	EBITDA, net income	Y7 EBITDA $4,052.4K → $4,474.7K

The balance sheet still balanced after each change. Rerun with `financial/.venv/Scripts/python.exe financial/tools/verify_model.py`.

7. Limits of this audit

We could not render the PDFs as images (no poppler on this machine) and read F5 through extracted text only; tables and charts may have lost layout. The `formulas` package could not evaluate F4 Financing!B4 (a `MATCH(TRUE, INDEX(range>=x,0),0)` array idiom), so we recomputed the milestone month by hand from year-end ARR. The other F5 figures we did not trace back to F4 are listed in `financial/scenarios.md` under open questions. Market-researcher asked that the repo figure for the freight-audit-and-payment market (~$3.1B) be dropped as unreproducible; this model never used it. The TAM work in `research/05` assumes a $40K shipper contract value and a 20% fee from the old five-year model, which differs from the revenue per account here ($13.0K-30.8K); the business plan should use one set.